

Distracting

A way to remember these skills is the phrase “**Wise Mind ACCEPTS.**”

With Activities:

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| ☐ Focus attention on a task you need to get done. | ☐ Go out for a meal or eat a favorite food. |
| ☐ Rent movies; watch TV. | ☐ Call or go out with a friend. |
| ☐ Clean a room in your house. | ☐ Listen to your iPod; download music. |
| ☐ Find an event to go to. | ☐ Build something. |
| ☐ Play computer games. | ☐ Spend time with your children. |
| ☐ Go walking. Exercise. | ☐ Play cards. |
| ☐ Surf the Internet. Write e-mails. | ☐ Read magazines, books, comics. |
| ☐ Play sports. | ☐ Do crossword puzzles or Sudoku. |
| | ☐ Other: _____ |

With Contributing:

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| ☐ Find volunteer work to do. | ☐ Call or send an instant message encouraging someone or just saying hi. |
| ☐ Help a friend or family member. | ☐ Make something nice for someone else. |
| ☐ Surprise someone with something nice (a card, a favor, a hug). | ☐ Do something thoughtful. |
| ☐ Give away things you don't need. | ☐ Other: _____ |

With Comparisons:

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| ☐ Compare how you are feeling now to a time when you felt different. | ☐ Compare yourself to those less fortunate. |
| ☐ Think about people coping the same as you or less well than you. | ☐ Watch reality shows about others' troubles; read about disasters, others' suffering. |
| | ☐ Other: _____ |

With different Emotions:

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| ☐ Read emotional books or stories, old letters. | <i>Ideas:</i> Scary movies, joke books, comedies, funny records, religious music, soothing music or music that fires you up, going to a store and reading funny greeting cards. |
| ☐ Watch emotional TV shows; go to emotional movies. | |
| ☐ Listen to emotional music. | ☐ Other: _____ |
| <i>(Be sure the event creates different emotions.)</i> | |

With Pushing away:

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| ☐ Push the situation away by leaving it for a while. | ☐ Notice ruminating: Yell “No!” |
| ☐ Leave the situation mentally. | ☐ Refuse to think about the painful situations. |
| ☐ Build an imaginary wall between yourself and the situation. | ☐ Put the pain on a shelf. Box it up and put it away for a while. |
| ☐ Block thoughts and images from your mind. | ☐ Deny the problem for the moment. |
| | ☐ Other: _____ |

With other Thoughts:

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| ☐ Count to 10; count colors in a painting or poster or out the window; count anything. | ☐ Work puzzles. |
| ☐ Repeat words to a song in your mind. | ☐ Watch TV or read. |
| | ☐ Other: _____ |

With other Sensations:

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| ☐ Squeeze a rubber ball very hard. | ☐ Go out in the rain or snow. |
| ☐ Listen to very loud music. | ☐ Take a hot or cold shower. |
| ☐ Hold ice in your hand or mouth. | ☐ Other: _____ |